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It will shock even hardcore gamers

GeForce Now changes the game, according to NVIDIA's John Gillooly

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With the cost of PC components like RAM and storage steadily rising, building or upgrading a gaming PC is no longer an easy decision. For many gamers, the barrier of entry has never felt higher. This is where cloud gaming starts to look less like a luxury and more like a solution. Last year, Microsoft launched the Xbox Cloud Gaming offering cloud-based gaming access in India. Now, Nvidia is about to launch the GeForce Now, its GeForce RTX-powered cloud gaming service, in India.

At the preview, I spoke with John Gillooly, Senior Technical Marketing Manager, APAC South to understand how this technology is better than what's already out there in the market and will it replace PC Gaming.

RTX 5080 from the Cloud

Gillooly explained that GeForce Now allows users to match the streaming experience to their device and internet connection. With a fast connection, around 100 Mbps and a high-end display, users can stream at 4K and up to 120Hz. On the performance front, Nvidia has confirmed that India will get RTX 5080 SuperPOD servers at launch. This is the same high-end infrastructure that NVIDIA has recently rolled out in other GeForce Now regions.

At the same time, the service can scale down for users with lower bandwidth or lower-resolution screens, offering flexibility instead of a one-size-fits-all experience. Gillooly explained that Nvidia spends a lot of time refining gaming technologies, whether

it is path tracing, DLSS, or Reflex and that same mindset carries over to GeForce Now.

Cloud gaming is not new, but Nvidia's focus is clear. GeForce Now is designed to give users a GeForce RTX PC in the cloud, not a simplified or console-like experience.

Tackling Latency

When asked where GeForce Now manages to reduce latency the most – encoding, server processing, or network routing, Gillooly made it clear that there is no single magic switch.

Nvidia focuses heavily on the parts it can control. On the server side, Nvidia uses Reflex technology and a network-based version of Reflex that prioritizes packets. The service also uses ConnectX-7 NICs, which are enterprise-grade networking components that offload packet processing from the GPU. This helps optimise performance and reduce delays.

On the user side, Nvidia uses technologies like Cloud G-Sync. If a user is playing on a G-Sync-enabled monitor, GeForce Now can vary the number of frames sent from the server based on the display's refresh rate, syncing the experience just like a local PC.

Gillooly explained that latency is not just about the network. There is network latency, and then there is "click-to-photon" latency. Nvidia focuses strongly on reducing the latter. As he put it, it is not one big improvement, but many small ones combined together to keep the latency down as much as possible.

India Pricing

As for pricing and tiers, Nvidia is keeping things under wraps for now. Gillooly did confirm that Nvidia is planning an India-specific beta, rather than simply copying a global model. More details on pricing and tiers will be revealed as the service moves closer to a full commercial launch. **d**